

Your First 90 Days in Ontario: Printable Checklists

Companion to Incontinence Care at Home: The Family Caregiver's Practical Handbook by Rujal Tuladhar. Print the pages you need; the supply list goes on the inside of the cupboard door. novatoronto.com/books/incontinence-care

First-week checklist

- Canadian phone number (prepaid SIM)
- Social Insurance Number, in person, confirmation letter kept
- Bank account: chequing, savings, credit card ordered, e-Transfer enabled
- Ontario health card applied for, every family member, confirmation kept
- Document folder assembled and scanned to phone and cloud
- Address updated with IRCC if changed since landing
- Transit card bought and registered
- Settlement agency intake booked
- Winter clothing if arriving in winter

The document folder

- Passports, all family members
- COPR or permits, signed
- Visa or eTA record
- Birth certificates, marriage certificate
- Degrees, diplomas, transcripts, translations, credential assessment
- Employment letters with dates and titles
- Driving record or licence history from home authority
- Medical and vaccination records, prescriptions
- Proof of funds, bank statements
- Any Canadian address, written down

Who may ask for your SIN

Yes: employer (for payroll), bank and investment accounts, CRA and government programs that require it. No: landlords (offer other proof), phone companies, gyms, stores, job applications before an offer, anyone who calls or emails you.

Rental viewing checklist

- Person showing it is the landlord or agent, with keys
- Water pressure, hot water, heating, windows, stove, fridge, locks
- Pests, mould, water damage
- What is included: heat, water, hydro, internet, parking, laundry
- Building management, repairs process, garbage, storage
- Phone signal inside
- Walk to transit at the time you would use it
- Photos of everything on move-in day
- Standard lease form used; only last month's rent deposit and a key deposit
- Pay only after signing, with keys in hand, by traceable method, with a receipt

Scam check

- Did they contact me first?
- Are they creating urgency or fear?
- Are they asking for payment by gift card, crypto, wire, or e-Transfer to a person?
- Are they asking for my SIN, PIN, passwords, or banking details?
- Did I find the organization's real number myself and call it back?
- Have I told someone before sending money?

The 90-day plan (summary)

Week	Focus
1	Phone, SIN, bank, health card, folder, transit, settlement agency booked
2	Needs assessment, rental search, library, CRA benefit forms, Health Care Connect, driving record, school contact
3	Lease signed, tenant insurance, internet, school registration, child care lists, credit card first use
4	Canadian resume, networking profile, credentials, first applications, CRA My Account, licence appointment
5–6	Language classes, a weekly place, phone plan, doctor search, weekly applications, mentoring
7–8	Licence exchanged or G1 done, cards received, benefits received, EarlyON, winter gear
9–10	Budget review, job-search review, scam check, housing review, children settled
11–13	Tax folder, credit report, professional development, savings accounts, community, next-90 list

Use sites that end in canada.ca or ontario.ca for government services. Everything below was checked in October 2026; search the page name on the official site if a link has moved.

Federal

- Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada, new immigrants: canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/new-immigrants.html
- Find free newcomer services near you: canada.ca (search "newcomer services near you")
- Social Insurance Number: canada.ca (search "apply for a SIN")
- Canada Revenue Agency, newcomers: canada.ca (search "newcomers CRA")
- Forms RC66 (Canada Child Benefit) and RC151 (GST/HST credit for new residents): canada.ca (search the form number)
- CRA My Account: canada.ca (search "CRA My Account")
- Free tax clinics: canada.ca (search "free tax clinics")
- Job Bank: jobbank.gc.ca
- Foreign credential recognition: canada.ca (search "foreign credential recognition")
- Language classes (LINC/CLIC): canada.ca (search "language classes newcomers")

- Financial Consumer Agency of Canada: canada.ca (search "FCAC newcomers")
- Canadian Anti-Fraud Centre: antifraudcentre-centreantifraude.ca
- College of Immigration and Citizenship Consultants, public register: college-ic.ca
- Discover Canada, the citizenship study guide: canada.ca (search "Discover Canada")

Ontario

- Apply for OHIP and get a health card: ontario.ca/page/apply-ohip-and-get-health-card
- Health Care Connect and Health811: ontario.ca (search the name)
- Guide to Ontario's standard lease: ontario.ca/page/guide-ontarios-standard-lease
- Landlord and Tenant Board: tribunalsontario.ca/lrb
- Exchange a foreign driver's licence: ontario.ca/page/exchange-out-province-drivers-licence
- DriveTest: drivetest.ca
- Employment standards: ontario.ca (search "employment standards")
- Employment Ontario: ontario.ca (search "Employment Ontario")
- Register your child for school: ontario.ca (search "register your child for school")
- Find and pay for child care: ontario.ca/page/find-and-pay-child-care
- EarlyON centres: ontario.ca (search "EarlyON")
- Ontario Trillium Benefit: ontario.ca (search "Ontario Trillium Benefit")
- Legal Aid Ontario, community legal clinics: legalaids.on.ca
- ServiceOntario locations: ontario.ca (search "ServiceOntario")

Community

- 211 Ontario: 211ontario.ca (dial 2-1-1)
- Settlement.Org: settlement.org
- Presto: prestocard.ca
- Toronto Public Library newcomer services: tpl.ca (search "newcomers")

My 90-day tracker (blank)

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